

Macys AI Coworker

AI supported campaign workflow . ten steps from brief to launch
Color shows who does the work. A human owns the real decisions.

Human

LLM skill

Automation

Human + LLM

Human review / approval



Final output: launched, localized campaign + executive report

A deterministic orchestrator routes between steps via shared state. Choices carry forward (segment to SKUs, copy, report).

Final Process Redesign: From Manual Campaign Production to an AI Supported Workflow

Macy's runs a promotional campaign through 10 steps from brief to launch. Today that takes 6 to 8 weeks, and the Creative steps in the middle (production, layout, review, and localization) are where everything slows down. Work gets handed off by email, Slack, and PDF, versions pile up with no real control, and the asset library degrades a little more every cycle. The redesigned process keeps people in charge of strategy, brand, and final approval, and hands the repetitive production and lookup work to AI skills, plain automations, and tool calls. Humans review at the points that actually carry risk.

1. What changed from the original process

In the original process every step was manual and disconnected. A price change made in a spreadsheet never reached the design files. An inventory shortage could stall the whole campaign. Approvals bounced around inboxes for days. In the redesigned process an AI coworker now segments the audience, checks for pricing conflicts, finds the right assets in the library, drafts and localizes the creative, and routes the work for approval. The handoffs are explicit and tracked, and every step is labeled by who owns it: green for a human task, red for an AI skill, blue for a plain automation, gold for a human and the AI working together, and purple for a human review and approval point.

2. Which steps should be faster or easier

The biggest gains come from segmentation, SKU selection, asset finding, localization, scheduling, and monitoring. These are lookup, generation, and rules based tasks where the AI does the heavy lifting and the person confirms. Based on our estimates, the full cycle drops by roughly 70 to 80 percent, which works out to about \$9,000 saved per campaign at a fully loaded labor cost of about \$75 per hour. The localization step alone goes from producing 40 to 50 regional files by hand to generating them in one pass.

3. Which steps still require human judgment

The brief is a human task: the Campaign Manager writes the strategy and brand intent using a structured form with validation and example presets, but no GenAI is involved at that step. Layout decisions involve an LLM draft that the designer reviews and refines. Most importantly, the review and approval gate stays human. At that gate the person sees the AI output, the source documents the AI used, the data behind any tool call, and a short summary of the AI reasoning, and can approve, edit, reject, rerun, or escalate. Final approval is never automatic.

4. Which steps are risky if fully automated

The approval and compliance step is the riskiest to automate, because a wrong claim or a mispriced offer is a legal and brand problem, not just a typo. Pricing is also sensitive, since an automated price could break a minimum advertised price agreement. Customer facing copy carries the same risk if it misstates an offer. These all keep a human gate. Our own testing showed the compliance skill sometimes flags clean copy for revision, which is exactly why a person reviews before anything ships.

5. What the AI coworker needs from data, tools, or documents

The coworker draws on loyalty and segment data, the SKU catalog, asset library metadata, and past campaign performance. It uses three tools: `check_pricing_conflicts` (validates SKU discounts against MAP rules), `find_dam_assets` (searches the DAM catalog by category and region), and `generate_locale_variants` (produces Spanish and Quebec French translations). It also retrieves from a set of 12 internal reference documents covering brand guidelines, compliance rules, pricing policy, and localization standards. Whatever the AI retrieves is shown to the user as evidence, so no one has to trust the output blindly.

6. What the final business output is

The output is an approved, compliant, localized campaign package ready to activate across channels, produced in a fraction of the original time, with an audit trail showing exactly what the AI did and what the human approved at each step.